



Photographs by GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times
METEOROLOGIST Edgar McGregor collects trash in the Santa Fe Dam Recreation Area in Irwindale.

Amid catastrophic loss, mighty San Gabriel Mountains beckon

In the post-Eaton fire rebuild, columnist seeks ideas for path ahead

Voices
STEVE LOPEZ COLUMNIST

In December 2020, a reader suggested I get in touch with a young Pasadena man named Edgar McGregor, who was approaching 500 straight days of picking up trash in local parks, including Eaton Canyon. I connected with McGregor by email but then got sidetracked by other things, as did he.

McGregor, now 25, still is picking up trash, and he also picked up a climate science degree at San José State in 2023. He operates a weather forecasting service out of his home, with a focus on the foothill communities of the San Gabriel Mountains, and has a keen interest in Santa Ana winds. This brought him a sizable following of people who paid close attention to his forecasts.

[See Lopez, A8]



McGREGOR tries to enjoy nature and not be angry with litterbugs.

Why California workers are taking a hit

Thousands have been laid off this year as AI shakes up the media and tech industries.

By LAURENCE DARMIENTO

California is among the world's largest economies, but the engines that drive it haven't been firing on all cylinders.

The state has been buffeted by a litany of layoffs this year from Hollywood to Silicon Valley — and beyond. Economists cite several explanations, including contraction in the entertainment industry, displacements caused by artificial intelligence and overall uncertainty in the national economy.

This year, thousands of workers at Amazon, Intel, Salesforce, Meta, Paramount, Warner Bros. and

Walt Disney Co. have lost their jobs. Even Apple just announced a rare round of cuts.

Seemingly no corner of entertainment and tech has been immune from the cost-cutting that has put workers on edge.

"People are hunkering down because they think a storm is coming," UC Berkeley labor economist Jesse Rothstein said.

Through October, there were 158,734 layoffs an-

nounced in California, compared with 136,661 for the same period last year. That was the most of any state, lagging behind only Washington, D.C., which has been hit hard by federal downsizing, according to outplacement firm Challenger, Gray & Christmas Inc.

Nationwide, the layoffs have topped 1 million for the year, the most since the pandemic began, according to Challenger.

[See Economy, A12]

Bipartisan demands for legal scrutiny of U.S. boat strikes

By KEVIN FREKING

WASHINGTON — Lawmakers from both parties said Sunday that they support congressional reviews of U.S. military strikes against vessels in the Caribbean Sea and eastern Pacific Ocean, citing a published report that Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth issued a verbal order for all crew members to be killed as part of a Sept. 2 attack.

The lawmakers said they did not know whether last week's Washington Post report was true, and some Republicans were skeptical, but they said attacking survivors of an initial missile

strike poses serious legal concerns.

"This rises to the level of a war crime if it's true," said Sen. Tim Kaine (D-Va.).

Rep. Michael R. Turner (R-Ohio), when asked about a follow-up strike aimed at people no longer able to fight, said Congress does not have information that that happened. He noted that leaders of the Armed Services Committee in both the House and Senate have opened investigations.

"Obviously, if that occurred, that would be very serious and I agree that that would be an illegal act," Turner said.

Turner said there are concerns in Congress about

the attacks on vessels that the Trump administration says are transporting drugs, but the allegation regarding the Sept. 2 attack "is completely outside anything that has been discussed with Congress, and there is an ongoing investigation."

The comments from lawmakers during news show appearances come as the administration escalates a lethal maritime campaign that it says is needed to combat drug trafficking into the United States.

On Saturday, President Trump said the airspace "above and surrounding" Venezuela should be considered "closed in its entirety."

[See Strikes, A10]



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times
USC students in a stand-up comedy class. The school offers a minor in comedy.

Tech, pre-med students at USC study comedy not just for laughs

By DANIEL MILLER

Under the harsh overhead lights of a small theater stage, the comedian commandeered the microphone and unfurled a short set laced with jokes about poop anxiety and penis size.

"My preschool had these communal restrooms — just five toilets lined up ... no barriers, no doors. It was like a

'1,000%' hike in attacks on ICE not seen in the records

A Times review finds scuffles but mostly no injuries, undercutting claim by president.

By JAMES QUEALLY AND BRITNY MEJIA

The federal prosecutor faced the jury, brandishing the item he said had been "used as a sword" to assault a federal officer during a July protest in downtown Los Angeles.

The object that Assistant U.S. Atty. Patrick Kibbe said was wielded as a weapon: an umbrella that an investigator needed a special scale to weigh because it was less than 1 pound.

For months, Trump administration officials have cited violence against federal law enforcement officers carrying out the president's deportation campaign as justification for aggressive tactics, including threats to deploy the National Guard and U.S. Mar-

ines. The Department of Homeland Security has touted a staggering figure, claiming a 1,000% increase in assaults against Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents.

But a Times analysis of court records related to assaults on federal law enforcement in Los Angeles, San Diego, Portland, Ore., Chicago and Washington shows the majority of the alleged attacks resulted in no injury to an agent. In roughly 42% of the cases The Times reviewed, federal law enforcement officers were either shoved, spat on or flailed at, or had water bottles thrown at them, according to court affidavits.

During the umbrella assault trial in October, prosecutors provided no evidence of any injuries. In L.A. and across the country, defendants accused of assaulting federal officers have won acquittals or seen charges dropped. More than a third of the cases The Times analyzed ended in dismissals or

[See ICE, A6]

3 children among dead in shooting at Stockton party

An adult is also killed and 11 are injured at a banquet hall. The gunman was at large.

By JESSICA GARRISON, JACK FLEMMING AND CAROLINE PETROW-COHEN

STOCKTON — Stockton was reeling after a gunman entered a banquet hall where more than 100 people had gathered for a family event Saturday night and opened fire, killing three children and one adult and wounding 11 others.

The mass shooting left people running for their lives and prompted an intense

manhunt for the gunman. Authorities asked the public for tips and surveillance footage, offering a \$25,000 reward for information that leads to an arrest, but said there was no threat to the community.

The violence reverberated across Stockton, a Central Valley city of 300,200 that has struggled with violent crime but has worked hard to curb it in recent years.

"This is Thanksgiving weekend. This is when families come together," said Mayor Christina Fugazi. "Stockton is better than this."

At a news conference Sunday afternoon, the mayor broke into tears, saying of the slain children: "They

[See Shooting, A10]

Witness to L.A.'s artistic liftoff
Critic Christopher Knight, in his final column for The Times, reflects on the city's art-world ascendance.
ENTERTAINMENT, E1

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How Maduro perseveres
In the face of U.S. threats, the Venezuelan leader's inner circle shows no sign of cracking.
WORLD, A2

Weather
Mostly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 71/50. **B5**

High-flying Rams tumble
Stafford commits three turnovers and defense is porous in 31-28 loss at Carolina.
SPORTS, D1

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